THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE · Nursery – Class XII · Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur · 9887258679

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME — SOCIAL SCIENCE · CLASS 9 · SET 01

Max. Marks: 80 · The Mastermind Coaching Classes, Jaipur · Alternate correct methods to be given full credit

SECTION A — Multiple Choice Questions — 20 questions · 20 marks

Select the most appropriate option. (20 × 1 = 20)

1. A flat-topped underwater mountain, usually a former seamount whose summit was eroded and later submerged, is called a:

(a) abyssal plain (b) guyot
(c) mid-ocean ridge (d) ocean trench

> **Ans: (b)** Guyot = flat-topped submerged seamount.

2. **Assertion (A):** Weather events such as clouds, rain and storms occur mostly in the troposphere.
Reason (R): The troposphere contains most of the water vapour and dust of the atmosphere.

> **Ans: (a)** Water vapour and dust are concentrated in the lowest layer, hence weather happens there.

3. When the price of tomatoes rises sharply, farmers in a district start growing more tomatoes. This behaviour illustrates the:

(a) Law of Demand (b) Law of Diminishing Returns
(c) principle of equilibrium (d) Law of Supply

> **Ans: (d)** Price rises → quantity supplied rises (direct relation).

4. Arrange the following battles in chronological order: (i) Haldighati (ii) Khanua (iii) Talikota (iv) Saraighat.

(a) (ii), (iii), (i), (iv) (b) (i), (ii), (iii), (iv)
(c) (ii), (i), (iii), (iv) (d) (iii), (ii), (iv), (i)

> **Ans: (a)** Khanua 1527 → Talikota 1565 → Haldighati 1576 → Saraighat 1671.

5. The Election Commission of India is a constitutional body set up under Article:

(a) 14 (b) 19 (c) 324 (d) 356

> **Ans: (c)** Articles 324–329 deal with elections.

6. A written plan that tries to balance a person's income and expenses is called a:

(a) premium (b) dividend (c) budget (d) mortgage

> **Ans: (c)** Budgeting = planning in advance how income will be spent.

7. The earliest known evidence of farming and herding in the Indian subcontinent (about 7000 BCE) comes from:

(a) Mehrgarh (b) Lothal (c) Kalibangan (d) Uttaramerur

> **Ans: (a)** Mehrgarh in Balochistan (Neolithic).

8. Cuneiform, a wedge-shaped script written on clay tablets, was developed in:

(a) the Indus valley (b) ancient Egypt
(c) the Yellow River valley (d) Mesopotamia (Sumer)

> **Ans: (d)** Egypt used hieroglyphs; Harappan script is undeciphered.

9. Read the statements and choose the correct option.
Statement 1: Government refers to the institutions and authorities that exercise political power.
Statement 2: Governance and government mean exactly the same thing and can be used interchangeably.

(a) Both statements are correct
(b) Statement 1 is correct, Statement 2 is incorrect
(c) Statement 1 is incorrect, Statement 2 is correct
(d) Both statements are incorrect

> **Ans: (b)** Governance is the process of making, implementing and monitoring decisions; government is the institution.

10. Which of the following is NOT one of the four seasons recognised by the India Meteorological Department?

(a) Winter
(b) Spring
(c) South-west monsoon
(d) Post-monsoon

> **Ans: (b)** IMD: winter, pre-monsoon, south-west monsoon, post-monsoon (retreating monsoon).

11. Small forest patches protected by local communities for religious and cultural reasons are known as:

(a) biosphere reserves
(b) sacred groves
(c) national parks
(d) game reserves

> **Ans: (b)** Over 1,00,000 sacred groves exist in India.

12. The principle that everyone, including the rulers, must obey the same laws is called:

(a) popular sovereignty
(b) separation of powers
(c) rule of law
(d) universal franchise

> **Ans: (c)** A key principle of democracy.

13. Shri Mahila Griha Udyog Lijjat Papad was organised on the principle of a:

(a) cooperative society in which every member is an equal owner
(b) private limited company owned by one family
(c) government-owned enterprise
(d) foreign-funded partnership

> **Ans: (a)** Seven women began in 1959; registered in 1962 as a cooperative.

14. In a planned economy, the decisions on what, how and for whom to produce are mainly taken by:

(a) consumers through prices
(b) foreign investors
(c) village panchayats
(d) a central authority

> **Ans: (d)** Central planning.

15. The Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ) of a coastal country extends up to _____ nautical miles from the baseline.

(a) 12 (b) 24 (c) 350 (d) 200

> **Ans: (d)** Territorial sea 12 nm; contiguous zone 24 nm; EEZ 200 nm (UNCLOS).

16. The Uttaramerur inscriptions of the Chola period are famous for describing:

(a) the conquest of Sri Lanka
(b) rules for the election of village council members
(c) tax on sea trade
(d) the construction of Brihadisvara temple

> **Ans: (b)** Evidence of village self-government.

17. Match Column I with Column II and choose the correct option.

Column I	Column II
(a) Lachit Borphukan	1. Battle of Khanua

(b) Rāṇā Sāngā	2. Ended the Madurai Sultanate
(c) Kumāra Kampana	3. Battle of Saraighat

(a) a-3, b-1, c-2 (b) a-1, b-3, c-2 (c) a-3, b-2, c-1 (d) a-2, b-1, c-3

> **Ans: (a)** Lachit – Saraighat (1671); Rana Sanga – Khanua (1527); Kumara Kampana, son of Bukka, ended the Madurai Sultanate.

18. In India, members of the Lok Sabha are elected through the:

(a) single transferable vote
(b) list system of proportional representation
(c) First-Past-the-Post system
(d) indirect election by MLAs

> **Ans: (c)** The candidate with the most votes in a constituency wins.

19. Insurance works mainly on the principle of:

(a) risk sharing among many people through a common pool of premiums
(b) guaranteed profit to every policyholder
(c) lending at low interest
(d) paying tax in instalments

> **Ans: (a)** Many pay premiums; those who suffer loss are compensated.

20. A fan-shaped landform built by a river as it enters the sea, by depositing silt, is a:

(a) gorge (b) delta (c) cirque (d) stack

> **Ans: (b)** Deposition near the mouth.

SECTION B — Very Short Answer Type — 4 questions · 8 marks

Each question carries 2 marks. Answer in about 40 words. (4 × 2 = 8)

21. Distinguish between ‘needs’ and ‘wants’ with one example of each.

> Needs (1): essentials without which life is difficult, e.g., food, water. Wants (1): things desired for comfort or pleasure, e.g., a gaming console.

22. What is a tide? Distinguish between a spring tide and a neap tide.

> Tide = rhythmic rise and fall of ocean water twice a day (½). Spring tide: Sun, Earth and Moon in a line (full/new moon) – very high high-tides (1). Neap: Moon in first/third quarter, Sun and Moon pull in different directions – smaller range (½).

O R

What is the ‘Blue Economy’? Which Sustainable Development Goal is linked with it?

> Sustainable use of ocean resources for economic growth, better livelihoods and ocean health (1). SDG 14 – Life Below Water (1).

23. Name two movements in which forest-dwelling communities protected trees, and the State in which each began.

> Bishnoi movement (Rajasthan, led by Amrita Devi) – 1; Chipko movement (Uttarakhand) – 1.

24. Distinguish between direct democracy and representative democracy.

> Direct (1): people take decisions themselves, practical in small communities. Representative (1): people elect representatives who take decisions on their behalf, used in large countries like India.

SECTION C — Short Answer Type — 5 questions · 15 marks

Each question carries 3 marks. Answer in about 60 words. (5 × 3 = 15)

25. Explain how the Harappan civilisation was different from the earlier Neolithic villages. Give three points.

> Any three (1 each): planned cities with grid streets and drainage; standardised weights, seals and bricks; long-distance trade; specialised crafts (bead-making); script (undeciphered); public structures like granaries/Great Bath.

26. After the Battle of Haldighati (1576), Mahārāṇā Pratāp did not surrender to the Mughals. Describe how he continued his resistance.

> Modified military strategy and adopted guerrilla warfare (1); used the rugged Aravalli terrain for surprise attacks, raids and ambushes on Mughal outposts (1); reclaimed most of his ancestral territories in the 1580s – Battle of Dewair, 1582 (1).

27. Explain any three effects of ocean currents on coastal regions.

> Any three (1 each): warm currents (Gulf Stream) keep ports ice-free (Norway); cold currents (Labrador) bring sea-ice; meeting of warm and cold currents → rich fishing grounds; affect temperature and rainfall; influence navigation.

OR

Explain three differences between weather and climate.

> Weather: short-term atmospheric condition, changes daily (1); Climate: average weather over about 30 years or more (1); weather is observed for a place at a time, climate describes long-run pattern of a region (1).

28. Distinguish between saving and investing. Why does investing protect the value of money against inflation? Use an example.

> Saving = keeping aside a part of income (1). Investing = putting savings into assets such as FDs, bonds, shares to earn returns (1). Example: a bag costing ₹1,000 costs ₹1,060 after 6% inflation; money merely kept at home loses purchasing power while invested money can grow faster than inflation (1).

29. Explain any three functions of the Election Commission of India.

> Any three (1 each): prepares and updates electoral rolls; schedules and conducts elections; registers political parties and allots symbols; ensures the model code of conduct; promotes voter inclusion through technology.

SECTION D — Long Answer Type — 4 questions · 20 marks

Each question carries 5 marks. Answer in about 120 words. (4 × 5 = 20)

30. ‘Every economy must answer three central questions.’ Name them and show how a market economy, a planned economy and a mixed economy answer them.

> Questions: what, how, for whom to produce (1). Market – decided through prices, demand and supply, profit motive (1.5). Planned – decided by central authority/government plan (1.5). Mixed – both private enterprises and government, e.g., India after 1991 (1).

OR

A farmer can grow wheat or barley on one plot. With the help of a table or diagram, explain the Production Possibility Curve and the idea of opportunity cost.

> Table/diagram with a downward-sloping curve, axes labelled (2). PPC = maximum combinations that can be produced with all resources (1). Opportunity cost = value of what is given up; it rises as more of one good is produced (1). Points inside show under-use, outside unattainable (1).

31. Explain with examples how the ocean floor and the movement of ocean water influence human life and the environment.

Relief: continental shelf rich in fish, oil and gas (1); trenches/ridges (1). Waves shape coastlines, tides help navigation and tidal energy, e.g., Gulf of Khambhat range about 12 m (1.5). Currents modify climate and create fishing grounds (1.5).

OR

Describe how the Indian Tsunami Early Warning Centre and other early warning systems protect coastal communities. Mention any four elements.

Detection by seismic stations and ocean-bottom pressure recorders (1); confirmation/tracking by tide gauges and radars (1); dissemination of alerts through satellite, SMS and email to government and public (1); cyclone warning services, GEMINI devices for fishermen (1); public awareness and training (1).

32. Describe the rise of the Magadha mahājanapada and the structure of Mauryan administration.

Magadha: fertile plains, iron ore, forests (elephants), river routes, capable rulers (2). Mauryan administration: king advised by a council, provinces and districts, officials, spies, taxation, Pataliputra capital (3).

OR

Explain how the Saptāṅga ideal of state and the concept of dharma shaped ancient Indian kingship.

Seven limbs: king, minister, territory, fort, treasury, army, ally (2). King's duty to protect and give justice (1); dharma as ethical limit on power (1); assemblies and councils advised the king (1).

33. What is e-governance? Explain how it helps good governance and mention two limitations.

Definition – use of ICT by government for services, information, feedback (1). Benefits: transparency, speed, less paperwork, access without visiting offices (2). Limitations: needs devices, internet and digital skills; risk of excluding some groups (2).

OR

'Public policy is a continuous cycle.' Explain the stages of the policy process using the example of upgrading a hospital to make it accessible.

Problem identified (patients, NGOs) (1); government studies, consults stakeholders (1); plan prepared and funds approved (1); implementation – ramps, lifts, tactile paths (1); monitoring, feedback and improvement (1).

SECTION E — Source-based / Case-based Questions — 3 questions · 12 marks

Each question carries 4 marks (1 + 1 + 2). (3 × 4 = 12)

34. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.*

"India has a tropical monsoon climate. Most of the annual rainfall in the country comes from the south-west monsoon winds that blow from the sea towards the land between June and September. The retreating monsoon in autumn gives rainfall to the south-eastern coast. Farmers plan sowing according to the arrival of the monsoon, and delay or failure of the rains can affect crops, prices and even the country's economy."

(i) Which wind system brings most of India's rainfall?

South-west monsoon.

(ii) Name the IMD season that follows the south-west monsoon.

Post-monsoon (retreating monsoon) season.

(iii) Why is the monsoon often called the 'real finance minister' of India? Explain in two points.

Agriculture and rural income depend on timely rain (1); good/bad rain affects food prices, exports and government revenue (1).

35. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.*

"The National Education Policy 2020 was not drafted overnight. A committee of experts chaired by Dr

K. Kasturirangan studied the issue. The draft was shared with the public, and consultations were held with 2.5 lakh Gram Panchayats, 6,600 blocks, 6,000 urban local bodies and 676 districts. About 2 lakh suggestions were received and many were incorporated before the Union Cabinet approved the policy."

(i) Who chaired the expert committee that prepared the draft policy?

> Dr K. Kasturirangan.

(ii) About how many suggestions were received from the public?

> About 2 lakh.

(iii) How does this example show that public policy is made through a process of consultation and not by a single decision?

> Experts studied the issue, draft shared publicly (1); stakeholders consulted at all levels and suggestions incorporated before approval (1).

36. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.*

"The Right to Information Act, passed in 2005, allows any citizen to request information from public authorities. Officials must respond within a fixed time. The Act has been used by villagers to check ration records, by students to know their examination results and by citizens to ask how public money is spent. By making government work visible, it makes officials answerable to the people."

(i) In which year was the RTI Act passed?

> 2005.

(ii) Name one thing citizens have used RTI to find out.

> Ration records / examination results / how public money is spent (any one).

(iii) Explain how the RTI Act strengthens democracy. Give two points.

> Transparency of government (1); accountability of officials and informed participation of citizens (1).

SECTION F — Map-based Question — 1 questions · 5 marks

(1 × 5 = 5)

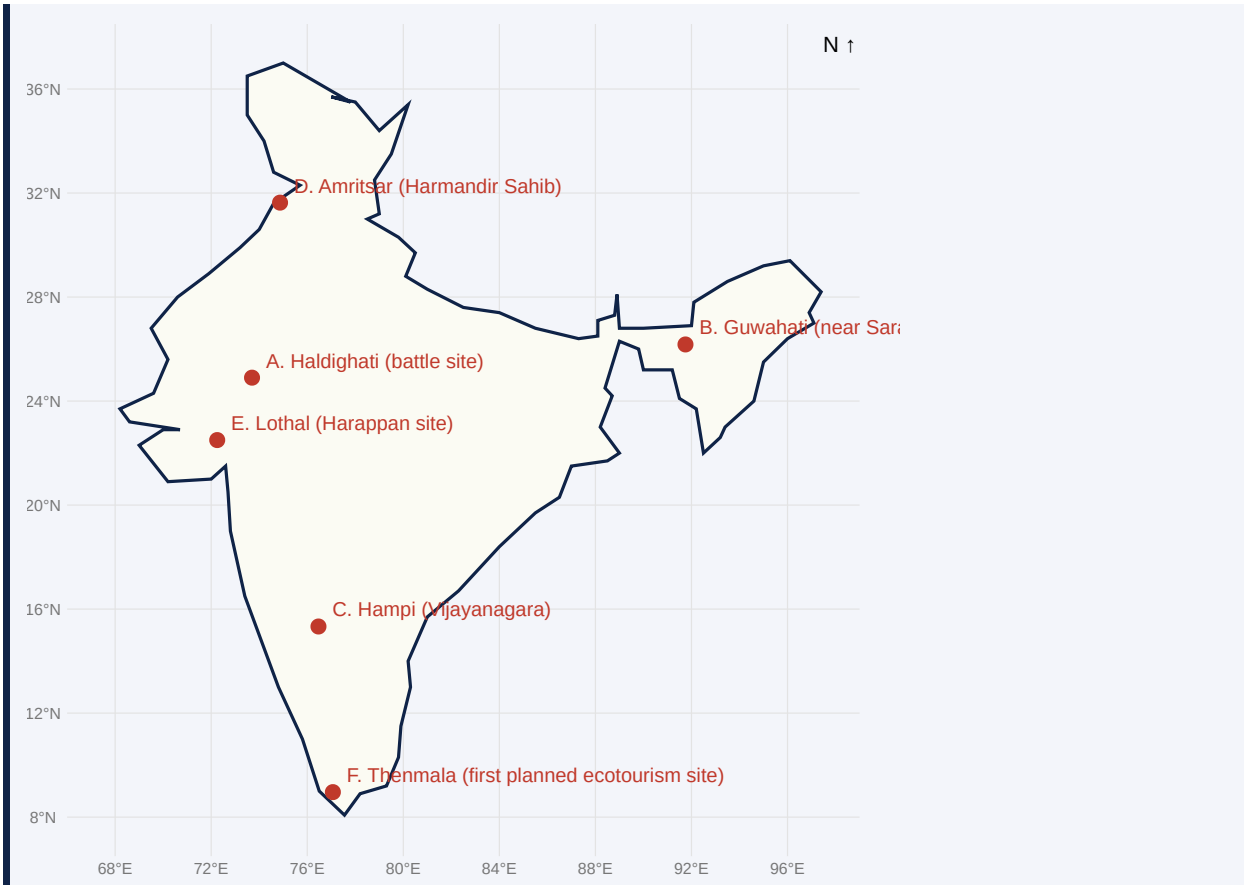
37. On the outline map of India provided, locate and label any **five** of the following (use the given letter/number for each): *Attempt any five. Each item carries 1 mark.*

A. Haldighati (battle site)
B. Guwahati (near Saraighat)
C. Hampi (Vijayanagara)
D. Amritsar (Harmandir Sahib)
E. Lothal (Harappan site)
F. Thenmala (first planned ecotourism site)

Note — in lieu of Q.37, for visually impaired candidates only (answer any five):

1. Name the State/UT in which Haldighati is located.
2. Name the State/UT in which Guwahati is located.
3. Name the State/UT in which Hampi is located.
4. Name the State/UT in which Amritsar is located.
5. Name the State/UT in which Lothal is located.
6. Name the State/UT in which Thenmala is located.

> 1 mark for each correctly located and labelled item (any five). Correct positions are shown below; answers marked within a tolerance of about 150 km are acceptable.


N ↑
36°N
32°N
28°N
24°N
20°N
16°N
12°N
8°N
68°E
72°E
76°E
80°E
84°E
88°E
92°E
96°E
D. Amritsar (Harmandir Sahib)
B. Guwahati (near Sara
A. Haldighati (battle site)
E. Lothal (Harappan site)
C. Hampi (Vijayanagara)
F. Thenmala (first planned ecotourism site)